

## Why have you not shared your fantasies with your partner?

Not comfortable sharing them 21

My partner will not understand and will get offended 18

I just fantasise about them but do not want to enact them

*For 3,456 respondents of the total 5,371 who have not shared their sexual fantasies with their partners. Rest don't know/can't say. All figures in per cent.*

**Sixty-four per cent respondents have never shared their sexual fantasies with their partners. Forty per cent of those who have not shared them said they just wanted it to remain in the imagined realm, while 39 per cent feared rejection.**



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PER CENT OF THOSE MARRIED WERE UNCOMFORTABLE ABOUT SHARING THEIR FANTASIES WHILE 20 PER CENT FELT THEIR PARTNER MIGHT GET OFFENDED.

Not only do imaginations of oneself as sexy get heightened, but also such imaginations are generalised to everyone in urban India. In fact, in the sex survey, what constitutes as an "urban" sample affords only a thin slice and is certainly not truly representative of middle-class urban India. It is a convenience sample with 57 per cent comprising shop-owners and clerical staff earning Rs 5-15,000 per month. Those who earn over Rs 15,000 a month are just 18 per cent. Yet, even though the findings may not apply equally to other segments of society and some aspects of our sexual lives are overlooked, what is interesting is the light it sheds on the mechanics of fantasy and marriage. Not only do more Indians in general, compared to Americans, think more about sex, Indian husbands think hard about sex. In the survey, 57 per cent of husbands think about it either three-four times a day, once, or more than once a day. My own study finds that three times as many husbands compared to their wives reported that they often thought of making out with someone else.

Sexier images set the stage for fuelling our imaginations, albeit improbably. For, when we cannot have happiness, we set about faking it. An example of this is that even though 94 per cent of husbands and wives reported they were "happy", two-thirds of married couples were not in work-

## What do you do about your hidden and unfulfilled fantasies?

Discuss them in an Internet chatroom 6

Read magazines that discuss them 17

**Do nothing 46**

Discuss them with my friends 25

Fulfill them with a prostitute 5

Indulge in phone sex 7

*Figures add up to more than 100 because of multiple choices. Rest don't know/can't say. All figures in per cent.*

ing marriages. Fantasies might provide a band-aid solution to retreat from a stressful phase in marriage or the need for personal growth that an institution such as marriage requires but they also accentuate personal and marital unhappiness. When asked "How do you feel about your unfulfilled fantasies?", 44 per cent wives and 60 per cent husbands said they either felt anxious or very anxious. Fantasy increases the stress on marriage.

What are these fantasies about? Let us take a brief look at them: 89 per cent of husbands fantasised about film